

Solfatara

Location Near Naples, Italy

The mythological home of Vulcan, the Roman god of fire, this shallow volcanic crater is part of the large, multi-cratered Campi Flegrei volcanic area. Solfatara has many fumaroles, which emit jets of steam and sulfurous fumes, as well as hot mud pools, but the volcano itself has been dormant since 1198. Mollusk burrows found 22 ft (7m) up three Roman columns show that the area has sunk below sea level and subsequently been uplifted again since the columns were erected. This is evidence of the uplifting and deflating of the caldera as a result of the filling and emptying of its magma chamber, a process called bradyseism.

Vulcano

Location Off north coast of Sicily, Italy

As with other volcanoes in the region, activity on this small island has resulted from the collision of the African and Eurasian plates. The volcanic cones here are of three different ages. The oldest are three ancient composite volcanoes, the cones of which have largely collapsed into their caldera. The more recent Fossa cone last erupted in 1888–90. This event was well studied and involved the ejection of blocks of rocks, lava bombs, and ash but no lava flows;

it gave its name to Vulcanian-type eruptions. The most recent cone is Vulcanello, which formed in 183 BCE and was last active in 1550.

The Dinaric Alps

Location From Italy to Kosovo, southeast Europe

Much of this range, which stretches 400 miles (645 km) along the eastern Adriatic coast, is made of limestone and dolomite, and these rocks display some of the most spectacular karst landscape features in the world. These include sinkholes, underground rivers, caves, and gorges where caves have collapsed. One of the biggest underground systems is at Škocjan Caves in Slovenia, through which a 21-mile- (34-km-) long underground section of the Reka River flows.

The Pindus Mountains

Location From the Albanian border to the Peloponnese, Greece

Greece’s longest range, the Pindus Mountains, are geologically, an extension of the Dinaric Alps (see above). Some peaks, including the highest—Mount Smólikas—are composed of metamorphic ophiolites, sections of ancient oceanic crust that have been uplifted high above sea level and subsequently eroded. Other



▲ HOODOOS AT CAPPADOCIA

areas are made up of limestone and dolomite, and have produced karst features. Vikos Gorge, in the far north of the range, is one of the deepest gorges in the world, plunging 2,950 ft (900 m) in places.

Santorini

Location The Cyclades Islands in the Aegean Sea, Greece

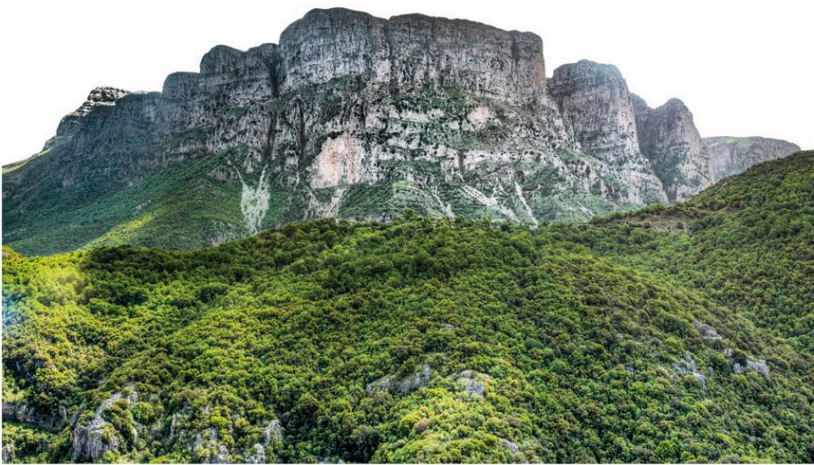
This oval archipelago is all that remains above sea level of a giant volcanic caldera. The islands of Thera, Aspronisi, and Therasia surround a lagoon that is 7 miles (12 km) by 4 miles (7 km). In 1610 BCE, Santorini produced one of the largest eruptions of the past 5,000

years, blasting 24 cubic miles (100 cubic km) of rock particles and ash into the atmosphere and producing a tsunami that devastated the north coast of Crete.

Cappadocia

Location Central Anatolia, Turkey

Ancient volcanic activity on this high plateau has given rise to one of the world’s most extraordinary landscapes, the “fairy chimneys” (hoodoos) of Goreme National Park. Volcanoes deposited thick layers of ash, which later consolidated into a rock called tuff, then covered it with basalt. Runoff from heavy rainfall cut gullies through the resistant



▲ MOUNT SMÓLIKAS IN THE PINDUS MOUNTAINS